2. This utility can be used for a file on any filesystem.

—***Rajesh Battala, brajesh@novell.com***

Change your default editor in Debian/ Ubuntu

Execute the following command:

```
sudo update-alternatives --config editor
```

The options in my Debian system are:

```
There are 6 alternatives which provide 'editor'.

 Selection    Alternative

-----------------------------------------------

       1    /bin/ed

       2    /bin/nano

       3    /usr/bin/vim.tiny

*+      4    /usr/bin/vim.gnome

       5    /usr/bin/mcedit-debian

       6    /usr/bin/emacs21
```

Press enter to keep the default[*], or type selection number:

The + sign denotes the default option, and the * sign denotes the actual selection; to change from vim to nano, just press 2 in this example and then press ENTER.

Now, all applications that use an editor will use the new default one.

—***Remin Raphael, remin@smartgeek.co.cc***

Copy files to and from archives

cpio is a tool to copy files from one place to another, and to create archives (like tar), or extract files from an archive file.

The good thing is that *cpio* takes its input from other commands like *ls* or *find*. So you can archive all *.mp3* in your home directory by entering the following command:

```
ls *.mp3 | cpio -o --format=tar -F mymp3.tar
```

Or, if you want to include sub-folders, use the code:

```
find $HOME -name "*.mp3" | cpio -o --format=tar -F mymp3.tar
```

You can list the contents of a *.tar* file, as follows:

```
cpio -it -F mymp3.tar
```

And to extract them, use the command below:

```
cpio -i -F mymp3.tar
```

—***Remin Raphael, remin13@gmail.com***

A shell inside Vim

While editing some text in Vi or Vim you may want to execute some shell commands. To do so, go to *esc* mode and execute the command as follows:

```
:!sort # for sorting the text contents
```

If you want to use a shell (while programming) use the following commands:

```
:sh
```

Now you can use a shell. After finishing the task with the shell, press *^D* to return to the file.

—***Jaganadh G, jaganadhg@gmail.com***

Nmap tips

Many systems and network administrators find nmap useful for tasks such as network inventory, managing service upgrade schedules, and monitoring host or service uptime.

For checking the local system, use the following code:

```
# nmap localhost
```

To check the remote system, issue the command given below:

```
# nmap <ip>
```

—***Sivakumar E, sivakumar.e@gmail.com***

END

Share Your Linux Recipes!

The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in LFY so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at *www.linuxforu.com*. The sender of each published tip will get an LFY T-shirt.